Exhibit 10.5

TRADEMARK LICENSE AGREEMENT

This TRADEMARK LICENSE AGREEMENT (the "Agreement") is effective as of the [•] day of [•], 2019 ("Effective Date") between Morgan Stanley Investment Management Inc. ("Licensor"), and Morgan Stanley Direct Lending Fund, a Delaware corporation ("Licensee").

WHEREAS, Licensor is the owner of all rights to the trademark "Morgan Stanley" and the "Morgan Stanley" design (collectively, the "Brand");

WHEREAS, Licensee is a closed-end investment company that has elected to be treated as a business development company under the Investment Company Act of 1940, as amended (together with the rules promulgated thereunder) (the "Licensee Business");

WHEREAS, in connection with Licensee's public filings, requests for information from state and federal regulators, offering materials and advertising materials, and press releases, Licensee desires to state in such materials that investment advisory services are being provided by Licensor (or an affiliate thereof) to Licensee (collectively, the "Permitted Activity"); and

WHEREAS, Licensor is willing to permit Licensee to use the Brand for the Permitted Activity, subject to the terms and conditions herein.

NOW, THEREFORE, in consideration of the premises and the mutual promises and covenants contained herein and for other good and valuable consideration, the receipt and sufficiency of which is hereby acknowledged, the parties agree as follows:

1. Grant of Rights; Sublicensing.

Section 1.1. License Grant. Subject to the terms and conditions herein, Licensor hereby grants to Licensee a non-exclusive, non-transferable, and (subject to Section 1.2 hereof) non-sublicensable license for the use of the Brand solely for the Permitted Activity.

Section 1.2. Sublicensing. Licensee may sublicense its rights under Section 1.1 solely to a current or future wholly owned subsidiary of Licensee, and then only with the prior written consent of Licensor (which shall not be unreasonably withheld), provided that any such sublicense shall terminate automatically, with no need for written notice to the sublicensee, if (a) such entity ceases to be a wholly owned subsidiary of Licensee, (b) this Agreement terminates for any reason or (c) such sublicensee materially breaches its sublicense in a manner that harms the Brand and does not cure the same within 15 days after notice from Licensor or Licensee. Licensee shall notify Licensor promptly after becoming aware that any sublicensee has breached its sublicense and shall ensure that all sublicenses provide (i) for the foregoing termination rights of Licensor and (ii) obligations for sublicensee with respect to the Brand that are consistent with those of Licensee herein. Any act or omission by a sublicensee that would breach this Agreement if committed by Licensee shall constitute a breach of this Agreement by Licensee.

2. Ownership. Licensee acknowledges and agrees that, as between the parties, Licensor is the sole owner of all right, title and interest in and to the Brand. Licensee agrees not to do anything inconsistent with such ownership, including (i) filing to register any trademark or service mark containing the Brand or (ii) directly or indirectly challenging, contesting or otherwise

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disputing the validity, enforceability or Licensor's ownership of the Brand (and the associated goodwill), including without limitation, in any claim, allegation, action, demand, proceeding or suit ("Action") regarding enforcement of this Agreement or involving any third party. The parties intend that any and all goodwill in the Brand arising from Licensee's or any applicable sublicensees' Permitted Activity shall inure solely to the benefit of Licensor. Notwithstanding the foregoing, in the event that Licensee or any sublicensee is deemed to own any rights in the Brand, Licensee hereby irrevocably assigns (or shall cause such sublicensees to assign), without further consideration, such rights to Licensor together with all goodwill associated therewith.

3. Use of the Permitted Activity.

Section 3.1. Quality Control. Licensee's Permitted Activity shall be in a manner consistent with Licensor's high standards of and reputation for quality, and in accordance with good trademark practice wherever any of the same are used. Licensee shall not take any action that could reasonably be expected to harm the Brand or the goodwill associated therewith. Licensee shall use with the Brand any applicable trademark notices as may be requested by Licensor or required under applicable laws, regulations, stock exchange and other rules ("Laws") and reputable industry practice.

Section 3.2. Prior Written Approval. Prior to using the Brand in any manner, Licensee shall submit all proposed uses to Licensor for prior written approval.

Section 3.3. Compliance with Laws. Licensee shall, at its sole expense, comply at all times with all applicable Laws and reputable industry practice pertaining to the Licensee Business and Permitted Activity.

4. Termination.

Section 4.1. Term. The term of this Agreement commences on the Effective Date and continues in perpetuity, unless termination occurs pursuant to Sections 4.2 through 4.4.

Section 4.2. Termination for Convenience. Licensor reserves the right to terminate this Agreement immediately upon written notice for any reason, including if the usage of the Brand is not in compliance with the standards and policies.

Section 4.3. Termination for Breach. If either party materially breaches one or more of its obligations hereunder, the other party may terminate this Agreement, effective upon written notice, if the breaching party does not cure such breach within 15 days after written notice thereof (or any mutually agreed extension). Licensor may terminate this Agreement immediately, effective upon written notice, if (i) Licensee attempts to violate Section 8 or (ii) a sublicensee materially breaches its sublicense in a manner that harms the Brand, and (a) such sublicensee does not cure the same within 15 days after notice from Licensor or Licensee or (b) Licensee does not terminate such sublicense within 15 days after notice from Licensor.

Section 4.4. Termination of Advisory Agreement. This Agreement shall terminate automatically without notice and immediately (a) if MS Capital Partners Adviser Inc. or another affiliate of Licensor is no longer acting as the investment adviser (any such entity, the "Advisor") to Licensee under the Investment Advisory Agreement, dated as of [•], 201[9] (as the same may

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